

a separate control scheme for controllers. We tried it with a controller and have zero regrets.

Coming to the core gameplay, this game is basically a 2D dungeon platformer and side scroller. If you've ever played Dead Cells then you'll find this game to be extremely similar to it but obviously, there are some major differences. For each round, you'll get three weapons which you can choose beforehand. Using those three weapons, you need to kill all the enemies and advance to the next chamber.

You'll progress through the current level till you encounter the boss. Defeat him and the chamber is cleared. Sometimes, during the run, you may encounter special rooms where chests are kept. Opening the chests will give you a free powerup but it'll only be valid for your current run. Another thing that you can spot while playing the game is the Dream Merchant's shop. This shop will appear at random times in random rooms. Here, you can replenish your HP and buy power ups using the gold coins that you've collected.

There's also a full blown powerup shop which you can visit before each round starts. There are a lot of powerups in the game but at a time, only eight are available to buy. The power ups will change periodically and there is a slight chance of the player getting a rare powerup too.

Finally, the movement mechanics for this game were a bit finicky. Since this is a 2D, side scroller game, there's no need for the 'Up' and 'Down' key. There's 'Left' and 'Right' for movement, 'C' for jump, 'X' for attack and 'Z' for dash. Pressing the jump button two times will result in a double jump and if you do it while you're near a wall, you can wall jump too. You can drop through some specific platforms by holding the 'Down' and the jump key and finally you can block / parry with the Ctrl key.

COMBAT

The game has two special attack bars. The first one charges up periodically while you kill enemies, after which you can invoke a special attack which will deal extra damage. We were quite satisfied with this special attack until the "Overload" mode came along. Overload mode boosts your damage, speed, and will make your enemy fire bullets in all directions. This will be a temporary boost for a few seconds till the Overload bar drains. After that, you'll return back to normal. We personally think that the addition of this Overload bar just makes things a tad bit more complicated. Plus, we never encountered a situation where we desperately needed to use the Overload mode.

There's also a lack of variety when it comes to enemies. Because of this, we quickly memorised the best ways to deal with the few we encountered.

The bosses on the other hand, are REALLY hard to beat. We know that bosses are supposed to be hard, but when you barely struggle against the small fry and die in literal seconds against the boss, there is definitely something wrong.

We really liked the weapon cycling system in the game. There is only a limited number of times that you can cycle through the weapons, after which the "weapon change" bar drains. This forces you to play with different weapons and experiment with them. When you swap from one weapon to another, the weapon that you swapped to gets a temporary boost and perk from the previous weapon.

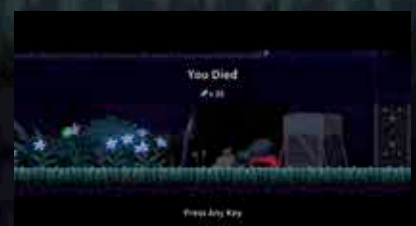
CONCLUSION

Roguelike games are supposed to be action packed, hardcore and rage inducing while retaining almost infinite replayability and giving at least one thing new to the user in each run. Nightmare: The Lunatic



does none of that. Well, we kinda liked the game anyway. The game has FANTASTIC graphics. It uses pixel art and it does not fail to deliver. The Dream Merchant, the main character, the weapons and the enemies are all drawn to perfection and we really couldn't expect anymore from the devs. As far as graphics are concerned, they have done a REALLY good job. Even though the combat has its own set of flaws, it feels moderately fun to play. The different dashing and weapon combos add some freshness to each run.

All in all, Nightmare: The Lunatic is a mediocre game with above average gameplay. While it has some elements from roguelike games, we'd rather not classify it as a proper "roguelike" game. Although, if you have some hot takes of your own about this game, you can convey them to us at editor@skoar.in *



MOAR!

DEVELOPER

Maetdol Games

PUBLISHER

Maetdol Games

PLATFORMS

Microsoft Windows

PLAYED ON

Microsoft Windows

PRICE

₹459 (Steam)